[METRIC]

A-A-1217B
March 22, 1994
SUPERSEDES
A-A-1217B
November 20, 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

INDEX SHEET SET, LOOSE-LEAF BINDER (BUFF)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description, for all Federal Agencies.

1. Scope: This description covers buff, alphabetical index sheet sets for general purpose use in looseleaf binders.

2. Salient characteristic:

2.1 The index sheet set paper shall conform to the requirements of JCP J10 for a basis weight of 120 g/m^2 (32 pounds). Grain direction of the paper shall be parallel to the long dimension of the index sheet. Color of the paper shall be buff. The index sheets shall be available in the sizes listed in Table 1.

Table 1

Sheet Size[1], mm (inch)	Spacing of holes[2], mm (inch)
184.151 x 107.950 (7.25 x 4.25)	69.850 (2.75)
215.901 x 279.401 (8.5 x 11)	69.850 (2.75)
241.301 x 152.401 (9.5 x 6)	88.900 (3.5)
279.401 x 215.901 (11 x 8.5)	107.950 (4.25)

[1]Sizes are exclusive of tabs with a tolerance of ± 0.794 mm (0.0312 inch), binding side cited first.
[2]Center to center with a tolerance of ± 1.588 mm (0.0625 inch.

Corners of the sheet shall be square or rounded. Along the binding edge, the index sheet shall have three (3) holes punched. Holes shall be 6.350 mm (+ 1.588 mm - 0.000 mm) (0.25 inch (+ 0.0625 inch - 0.0000 inch)) in diameter and shall be 9.525 mm ± 1.588 mm (0.3750 inch ± 0.0625 inch) from the edge of the sheet to the center of the holes. The top and bottom holes shall be equidistant from top and bottom edge of sheet, with a tolerance of ± 1.588 mm (0.0625 inch). Binder holes shall be reinforced on one or both sides with either the same stock as the index sheet set or a clear polyester film such that the reinforcement extends 4.763 mm ± 0.794 mm (0.1875 inch ± 0.0312 inch) around the hole and may extend to the binding edge of the sheet. Each index sheet shall be furnished with a self tab located opposite the binding edge of the sheet. Tabs shall be 12.700 mm ± 1.588 m (0.5000 inch ± 0.0625 inch) high and a minimum 12.700 mm (0.5000 inch) long, as

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measured at the midpoint of the tab height. Top corners of the tabs shall be rounded. Tabs shall be printed with black letters on both sides starting with "A" tab in the upper position and continuing downward on consecutive sheets for a total of 25 subdivisions with one "MC" and one "XYZ". The tabs shall be completely laminated with a clear polyster film such that the material extends onto the index sheet on each side not less than 9.525 mm (0.3750 inch) and extends over each end of the tab edge on the index sheet not less than 9.525 mm (0.3750 inch). The index sheets shall have clean cut edges and shall be free from wrinkles, folds, tears and other defects which affect serviceability. Tabs shall be free from cracking and peeling.

2.2 Bleaching: To obtain an acceptable brightness, in accordance with the performance standards of this document, a chemical bleaching process may be used. When specified in the ordering data (See Ordering Data), the bleaching process shall not include the use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, or other chlorine compounds. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

2.3 Workmanship. The end item shall be free of any defects such as, paper dust, grit spots, wrinkles, folds, holes, tears and smudges or any other defects that may affect appearance or serviceability. The edges of the end item shall not be nicked or uneven and shall be clean cut and lint free.

3. Quality Assurance Provisions. Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government.

Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Testing, when applicable, shall be in accordance with Part 2, Testing Standards and Definitions, of the Government Paper Specification Standards published by the Joint Committee on Printing. (Note: See individual TAPPI's for specific sampling instructions).

Acceptance criteria shall be as specified in Part 4, Acceptance Criteria, of the Government Paper Specification Standards published by the Joint Committee on Printing.

Sampling for preparation for delivery shall be in accordance with Mil Std. 105, Inspection Level S-2 and AQL 2.5% defective.

4 Regulatory requirements.

4.1 Certification. The contractor shall certify that the minimum content standard shall be no less than 50% recovered materials including 20% post consumer materials in accordance with Executive Order 12873, section 504 (b), dated October 20, 1993 (See definition of post consumer materials and recovered materials in sections 203 and 205). As an alternative to meeting the standards of section 504(b) for all printing and writing papers, the minimum content

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standard shall be no less than 50% recovered materials that are a waste material byproduct of a finished product other than a paper or textile product which would otherwise be disposed of in a landfill, as determined by the State in which the facility is located, in accordance with Executive Order 12873, section 504 (c), dated October 20, 1993. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4.2 Labeling. The recycled content shall be marked on the product or unit pack.

5. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling and marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

6. Application for copies of technical documents referenced herein: The issue date in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall be apply.

(1) TAPPI test methods are available from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, P.O. Box 105113, Atlanta, GA 30348.
(2) MIL-STD-105 is available from Standardization Documents Order Desk, Bldg. 4D, 700 Robbins Ave., Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.
(3) JCP specifications are for sale from Chief Paper Procurement Section, MMPP, U.S. Government Printing Office, North Capital and "H" St., NW, Wash DC 20401.
(4) Copies of Executive Order 12873, dated October 20, 1993 may be obtained from: The White House Publications Office, New Executive Office Building,White House, Att: Publications,Washington, DC. 20500 (202) 395-7332

7. Ordering Data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

A) Size
B) Whether bleaching without use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, or chlorine compound is required.
C) Packaging, packing, labeling and marking.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

DOD has waived coordination of this document

PREPARING ACTIVITY:
GSA-FSS

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